

Public evidence. A specific audience.

Landlord–tenant obligations | First research cohort | 16 September 2026

Start with regional third-party managers of conventional long-term single-family and small-multifamily rentals. Show useful deposit-closeout work inside their existing process—not a generic legal engine.

34 source entries · 7 case reconstructions · 6 prospect briefs · 3 demo specifications · 12 evaluation seeds

Four initial contacts

Prospect / geography	What the public workflow lets us show
Green Residential · TX Operations / owner review / accounting	Separate turn costs from tenant charges, then route approval and refund work. Published guide identifies AppFolio, RentCheck and homeowner review. [S18] [S19]
Red Door Company · NC Leadership + portfolio manager	A contractor-dependent case with separate interim and final accounting. Published end-to-end manager ownership; branded Propertyware portal. [S21] [S22] [S24]
Henderson Properties · NC Residential operations + accounting	A move-out is not complete until independent accounting tasks finish. Its instructions separately require cancellation of rent drafts. [S25] [S27]
Pioneer · CO Operations + property manager	A condition report is not a maintenance ticket. Use the firm's public form to show the connection to later repair and charge review. [S28] [S29]

Two later calibration conversations

Brink (Washington) adds changing roommates and a mature inspection process. **Good Life (California)** provides a photo-rich comparison. They test whether anything useful remains after existing tools—not whether those firms are failing. [\[S31\]](#) [\[S32\]](#) [\[S33\]](#) [\[S34\]](#)

Why this selection: similar operating work across three initial legal contexts; two NC firms allow comparison without changing the state rule. These are public leads, not contacted or qualified buyers. Portfolio counts and purchasing interest remain unverified.

This is not a five-state build commitment. The first actual partner determines the first legal regime and integration.

What the evidence shows

Reuse the mechanism. Re-derive the legal answer for the property, tenancy, agreement and event date.

1 / Cost allocation is a decision

The FTC complaint describes turn costs entering a resident ledger before a second review, with review allegedly skipped in some regions. The entered order addresses the named defendant's charging practices. **Demo implication:** owner work, proposed tenant charges and approved posting must remain distinct. [S01] [S02]

2 / A case can fail between systems

Pioneer's blank form explicitly distinguishes condition reporting from a maintenance request. Henderson separately instructs residents to notify Accounting to stop auto-drafts. **Demo implication:** one recorded event must not silently stand for another. [S29] [S25]

3 / Invoices and statements evolve

Silver v. Rudeen recounts a preliminary estimate followed by later invoices and a revised balance. Goodeill examines whether the manager diligently pursued the accounting. **Demo implication:** distinguish waiting, follow-up, interim work and final completion. [S04] [S05]

4 / A good system preserves valid deductions

In Pulley v. Milberger, the appellate court affirmed retention of a \$3,700 deposit and an additional \$2,000 landlord award on the supporting record. **Evaluation implication:** correct charges must succeed; automatic refunds or universal escalation are not success. [S06]

5 / Geography changes the output

NC has conditional interim/final accounting. Washington's current rule differs from the historical 14-day context of the cases above. Colorado's 2026 changes address returned refunds; California's current text addresses photos and multi-adult refund recipients. **Implementation implication:** same case structure, jurisdiction-specific decisions. [S09] [S10] [S11] [S13]

Two adjacent examples are retained for evaluation, not initial market expansion: the NCREC McMillan disciplinary account tests custody and authority; Pennsylvania's Home365 announcement tests actual completion despite software adoption. [S07] [S08]

Evidence status matters: allegations are not findings; consent terms are not nationwide law; Silver decided dismissal/limitations, not every underlying charge. Case notes and source locators are provided in the notebook.

Bring a worked example

These are constructed demonstrations informed by public evidence—not actual prospect cases or completed agent tests.

D01 / Green: allocate before charging

Assume a \$2,000 deposit, a supported \$250 tenant-caused repair and \$800 of ordinary owner repainting. Show the proposed **\$250 deduction / \$1,750 refund**, owner approval and separate accounting actions. Never route the full turn invoice into the resident ledger. [S18] [S14]

D02 / Red Door or Henderson: act before the final invoice

In a qualifying NC case at day 28, the extent of the repair claim is still unknown. Show the **interim accounting due within 30 days**, the assigned missing information, and the final-accounting requirement within 60. Do not invent a charge or use 60 as the ordinary deadline. [S09]

D03 / Pioneer: connect conditions and work

A move-in form records a cabinet problem; no service record is supplied; the move-out quote includes cabinet work. Show what was already documented, what may be new, and the **specific question needed for allocation**. Do not fabricate a maintenance request or repaired condition. [S29]

Adapt the conversation to the person

Audience	What to put in front of them
Operations / property manager	A case with a useful next action; ask what chasing or reconciliation it replaces.
Accounting / controller	Charge allocation, current recipients, approvals and actual payment/ledger status.
Owner / COO	Which recurring responsibility improves and what staff work remains—not a promise of maximum penalty avoidance.

Opening: “We reviewed your published workflow and built an example around this handoff. Which parts are already automatic, and where would this still miss how your team works?”

Next: implement one example, pair the operational user with accounting, and test it against a competent existing process. Keep one renewal/notice comparison question; do not open a second build now.

Files: the workbook contains filterable prospects, cases, workflows, law examples, demos, evaluations and sources. The full ZIP adds individual case/prospect notes and JSON/CSV. Originals were read in the browser but could not be downloaded; the bundle contains authored research and exact source URLs, not original exhibits.